

SCREEN-FREE SUMMER

The Screen-Free Summer Vault

129 boredom-busting activities to keep kids happy, busy & off screens — all summer long. Print at home. Grab one when boredom hits.

8 printable packs

129 activities

Zero prep

What's inside

129 activities across 8 packs. Print what you want, pop it in a binder, pull one out whenever you need it.

1	Backyard & Outdoor Boredom-Busters	20 activities
2	Rainy-Day Quiet Time	18 activities
3	Road-Trip & Travel Pack	16 activities
4	Sensory & Life-Skills Activities	15 activities
5	Kids' Kitchen (no-cook + easy)	12 activities
6	Screen-Free Reward System	10 activities
7	Weekly Summer Rhythm Planner	8 activities
8	Boredom-Buster Master Deck	30 activities

HOW TO USE THIS VAULT

- 1) Print the packs you like (all printer-friendly). 2) Slip them in a binder or laminate the reusable ones.
- 3) When boredom hits, let your child pick a page. Done.

1

PACK 1 · 20 ACTIVITIES

Backyard & Outdoor Boredom-Busters

Print-and-go ideas that send them outside and burn energy.

Nature scavenger hunt — find something rough, something that flies, a yellow flower, a heart-shaped rock.

Driveway chalk obstacle course — hop, spin, tip-toe along the chalk path.

Giant chalk tic-tac-toe — draw a grid, use rocks as markers.

Shadow tracing — trace your shadow at morning, noon, and evening; compare.

Sponge toss relay — soak sponges, race to fill a cup across the yard.

Fence “painting” — a bucket of water + a big brush = mess-free art.

Ice-cube rescue — freeze small toys, free them with warm water.

Backyard Olympics — long jump, bean-bag toss, balloon keep-up, medals.

Bug explorer log — find, draw, and count the bugs you spot.

Mud kitchen — old pots + dirt + water = an hour of “cooking.”

Kindness rocks — paint smooth rocks and hide them for neighbors.

Bubble station — mix dish soap + water; try giant-bubble wands.

Household obstacle course — hula hoop, broom hurdle, pillow leap.

Plant-a-cup garden — seeds in a cup, water daily, watch it grow.

Cloud-watching journal — draw the shapes you see in the sky.

Water-balloon target toss — chalk a target, aim and splash.

Nature mandala — arrange leaves, petals, and stones in circles.

Sprinkler dance / hose limbo — music optional, giggles guaranteed.

Sandbox treasure dig — bury coins or toys to excavate.

Backyard campout — build a fort, grab a flashlight, tell stories.

WHAT'S PRINTABLE

Scavenger hunt cards, chalk challenge poster, Olympics scorecard, bug log.

Quick win: Outdoor + a printed “mission” = 45 minutes of independent play.

2

PACK 2 · 18 ACTIVITIES

Rainy-Day Quiet Time

For the indoor days when you still need a calm house.

Quiet-time box checklist — sticker books, lacing cards, busy bags.

Build-a-fort cards — cushion castle, blanket cave, reading nook.

Calm-corner breathing poster — smell the flower, blow the candle.

Indoor treasure hunt — clue cards you fill with your own hiding spots.

Paper airplane squadron — fold, decorate, race for distance.

Origami boats — fold and float them in the sink or tub.

Fortune tellers — the classic folded paper game.

Sticker-by-number pages — match stickers to numbered spots.

Lacing cards — thread yarn around punched shapes.

Pom-pom color sort — tongs + a muffin tin = fine-motor fun.

Sock matching race — dump clean socks, beat the timer.

Indoor bowling — plastic cups + a soft ball.

Reading nook challenge — cozy up and finish five books.

Puzzle race — beat your own best time.

Drawing-prompt jar — pull a slip, draw what it says.

Shadow puppets — a flashlight and a blank wall.

Toy “museum” — set up favorites and make little labels.

Animal yoga cards — be a cat, a flamingo, a sleepy bear.

WHAT'S PRINTABLE

Quiet-time checklist, breathing poster, treasure-hunt clues, drawing prompts, yoga cards.

Quick win: A printed “quiet-time menu” turns rainy days from chaos to calm.

3

PACK 3 · 16 ACTIVITIES

Road-Trip & Travel Pack

Tested for car, plane, and waiting rooms.

License-plate bingo — spot plates and mark your card.

Spot-it bingo — cow, red car, bridge, water tower.

“Are we there yet?” countdown strip — color a box every 15 minutes.

Travel journal pages — draw what you saw, rate the snacks.

Would-you-rather cards — 50 silly travel prompts.

Window I-Spy checklist — tick off what you find.

Alphabet hunt — find A–Z on signs in order.

Story-building game — each person adds one line.

Color hunt checklist — find all the rainbow colors outside.

Sticker scene page — build a picture with reusable stickers.

Map-the-trip coloring page — mark your route.

Snack rating scorecard — give stars to each snack.

20 questions cards — guess the animal/object.

Audiobook listening log — draw your favorite part.

Dot-to-dot travel pack — connect to reveal the picture.

“Quiet mouse” challenge — who can stay calm the longest?

WHAT'S PRINTABLE

Bingo cards, countdown strip, travel journal, WYR cards, I-Spy list.

Quick win: One laminated bingo card = a quiet back seat for miles.

4

PACK 4 · 15 ACTIVITIES

Sensory & Life-Skills Activities

Play that secretly teaches. Great for toddlers and littles.

Rice sensory bin — scoop, pour, hide and find small toys.

Pasta scoop-and-pour bin — cups, spoons, funnels.

Water-bead bin — themed by color (supervise closely).

Pour-and-transfer station — move water between cups.

Sort-by-color tray — buttons, pom-poms, or blocks.

Practical-life cards — pour, sort, button, zip, fold a napkin.

Play-dough “count the spots” mat.

Play-dough “feed the monster” mat.

Color hunt — find 5 things of each color around the house.

Shape hunt — circles, squares, triangles indoors.

Helper-of-the-day chart — match small chores to ages.

Texture treasure bag — guess each object by feel.

Tweezers pom-pom transfer — into an ice tray.

Pasta-necklace threading — patterns by color.

Sticky-wall art — contact paper + torn paper shapes.

WHAT'S PRINTABLE

Sensory-bin recipe cards, play-dough mats, helper chart, practical-life cards.

Quick win: Sensory play buys you focused, independent time — and builds real skills.

5

PACK 5 · 12 ACTIVITIES

Kids' Kitchen (no-cook + easy)*Confidence-building food fun with minimal mess.***Fruit kebabs** — thread soft fruit onto straws.**Yogurt parfaits** — layer yogurt, fruit, and cereal.**Ants-on-a-log** — celery, nut/seed butter, raisins.**Trail-mix bar** — scoop and mix their own bag.**No-bake energy balls** — oats, banana, honey; roll and chill.**Rainbow veggie + dip plate** — arrange by color.**Chef checklist** — wash hands, gather, measure, clean up.**Taste-test scorecard** — rate new fruits and veggies.**Set-the-table placemat** — where the fork and cup go.**Smoothie “recipe roulette”** — pick a fruit from each column.**Sandwich shape cutouts** — use cookie cutters.**Frozen banana pops** — dip and freeze.**WHAT'S PRINTABLE**

Recipe cards, chef checklist, taste-test scorecard, placemat.

Quick win: Picture recipe cards let kids “cook” while you sip your coffee.

6

PACK 6 · 10 ACTIVITIES

Screen-Free Reward System

Make the screen-free habit stick — gently, without nagging.

Screen-free hour tracker — color a square for each hour.

Daily streak calendar — build a chain of screen-free days.

“Boredom = brilliant” idea-jar slips — cut, fold, pull one out.

Reward coupon — one extra bedtime story.

Reward coupon — stay up 15 minutes later.

Reward coupon — pick tonight’s dinner.

Reward coupon — choose a special outing.

Summer bucket-list poster — fill it in together.

“I did it myself” sticker chart — celebrate independence.

Family screen-free pledge page — everyone signs.

WHAT'S PRINTABLE

Tracker, streak calendar, idea-jar slips, coupons, bucket-list poster, pledge.

Quick win: Track the wins, not the screen time — kids chase the colored squares.

7

PACK 7 · 8 ACTIVITIES

Weekly Summer Rhythm Planner

A light, intentional structure — flexible, not a rigid schedule.

Weekly rhythm page — morning / afternoon / evening blocks.

Daily anchor card — “one outing, one rest, one create.”

Meal & snack jotter — plan the week's food at a glance.

Sunday reset checklist — restock, tidy, plan ahead.

Morning routine cards — get dressed, brush, breakfast.

Bedtime routine cards — bath, books, lights out.

Weekly chore wheel — spin or assign by age.

“Today I'm grateful for” line — one small gratitude a day.

WHAT'S PRINTABLE

Weekly rhythm page, daily anchor card, meal jotter, routine cards, chore wheel.

Quick win: A loose rhythm beats a strict schedule — and beats “what do we do today?”

8

PACK 8 · 30 ACTIVITIES

Boredom-Buster Master Deck

30 grab-one-and-go cards that pull from every pack — plus blanks to add your own.

1. Build a blanket fort

2. Draw your dream treehouse

3. Make a paper-airplane fleet

4. Have an indoor picnic

5. Go on a bug hunt

6. Create an obstacle course

7. Put on a puppet show

8. Invent a secret handshake

9. Write a letter to grandma

10. Build the tallest block tower

11. Sort toys by color

12. Make a comic strip

13. Play “the floor is lava”

14. Hide a treasure for a sibling

15. Make a magazine collage

16. Press some flowers

17. Have a one-song dance party

18. Build a marble run

19. Make a pretend restaurant menu

20. Do a 5-minute clean-up race

21. Invent a brand-new game

22. Paint a kindness rock

23. Start a nature journal

24. Build a fort for stuffed animals

25. Write your name in fancy letters

26. Make a paper crown

27. Set up a pretend post office

28. Do three animal yoga poses

29. List what you love about summer

30. Pick a card for someone else

WHAT'S PRINTABLE

Full 30-card deck + blank cards + a “pick a number 1–30” poster.

Quick win: When all else fails, “pick a card” ends the boredom debate in seconds.



You're doing a good job.

This vault is meant to make your summer lighter, not to add pressure. Use one page or all 129 — there's no “right” way, and a screen day here and there doesn't undo anything.

Loved it? The full CaroTech library lives at beacons.ai/carotech36

This is a general activity resource for families; it is not medical, educational, or developmental advice. Adapt activities to your child's age and always supervise water, kitchen, and craft play.